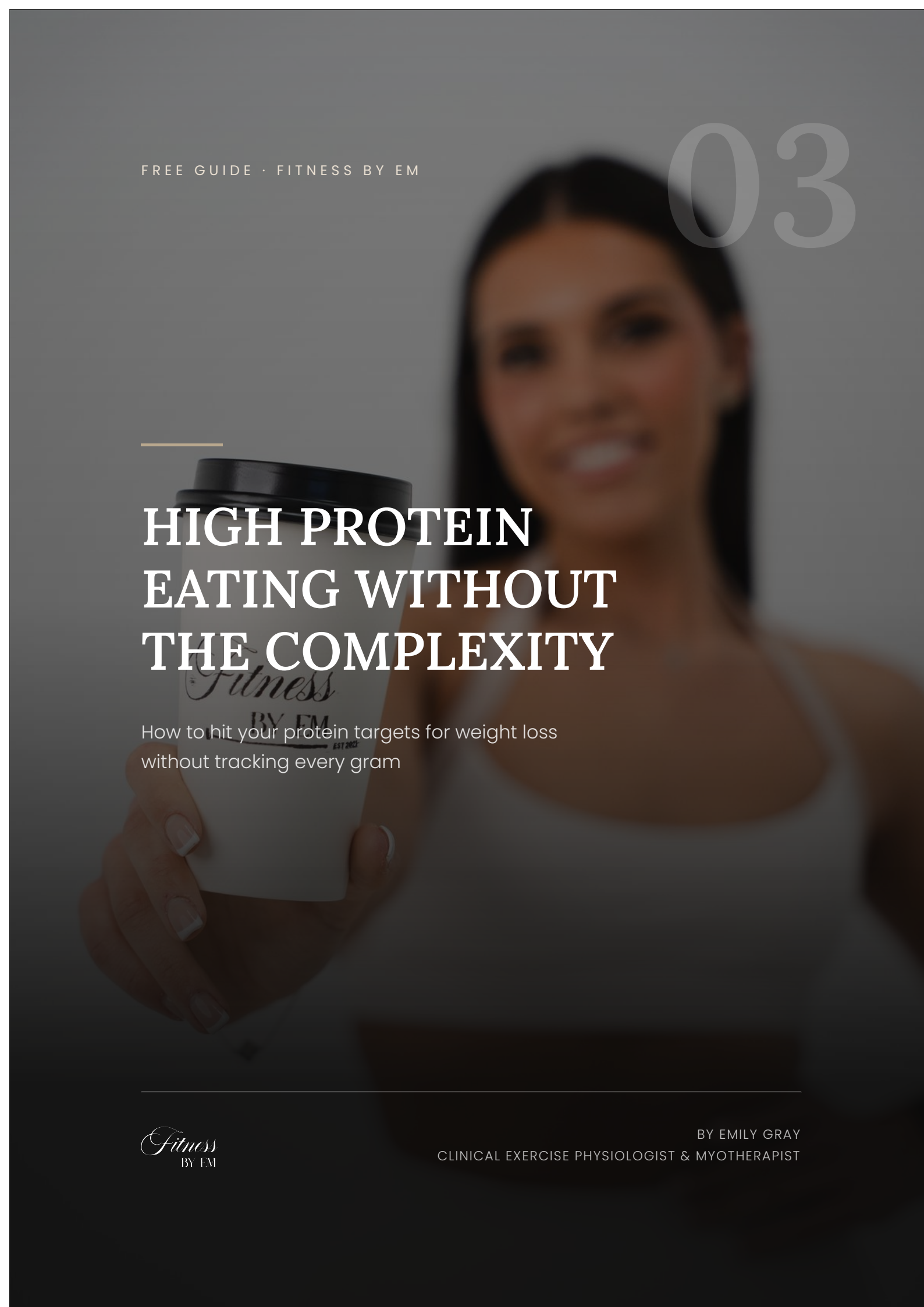
FREE GUIDE · FITNESS BY EM

03



HIGH PROTEIN EATING WITHOUT THE COMPLEXITY

How to hit your protein targets for weight loss without tracking every gram

Fitness BY EM

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NUTRITION · ALL LEVELS

HIGH PROTEIN EATING WITHOUT THE COMPLEXITY

How to hit your protein targets for weight loss without tracking every gram



1.6-2.2g	25-40g	450+
PROTEIN PER KG BODYWEIGHT	PROTEIN PER MEAL	WOMEN COACHED

Introduction

Protein gets talked about constantly in fitness spaces, and it can start to feel like one more complicated thing to manage on top of everything else. It doesn't need to be.

This guide gives you a genuinely practical approach to eating enough protein, without needing to weigh every meal, track every gram, or overhaul your entire diet overnight. You'll come away with a target, a food list, some simple meal templates, and the common mistakes that quietly sabotage most people's protein intake.

1. Why Protein Deserves The Priority

If you only changed one thing about how you eat, protein would give you the best return.

It preserves your muscle while you're in a calorie deficit, meaning the weight you lose is more likely to be fat rather than lean tissue, which is what actually changes how your body looks and feels.

It's the most filling macronutrient per calorie, which means adequate protein directly reduces hunger and makes a calorie deficit far more tolerable to sustain.

It supports recovery from training, helping you come back stronger for your next session rather than breaking down over time.

It has a higher thermic effect than carbohydrates or fat, meaning your body uses more energy simply digesting it.

Most women, without specifically focusing on it, eat well below what actually supports their goals. This isn't a failure of discipline, protein just isn't naturally front of mind the way carbohydrates and treats tend to be. A small, deliberate shift here has an outsized impact.

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2. How Much Protein Do You Actually Need?

A practical target for most women, particularly during a fat loss phase, is 1.6-2.2 grams of protein per kilogram of bodyweight per day.

For a 70kg woman, that's roughly 112-154 grams per day.

If that number feels overwhelming, here's the simpler version: aim for 25-40 grams of protein at each of your main meals, plus a protein-containing snack if you have one. Hit that consistently, and you'll land in the right range without ever picking up a food scale.

You do not need to be precise to the gram. Consistency across most days matters far more than hitting an exact number every single day. If you're roughly in the zone most of the time, you're getting the vast majority of the benefit.

3. The Protein Food List

> *Aim for 25-40 grams of protein at each main meal. That's the whole target, no gram-by-gram tracking required.*

Animal sources (typically the most protein-dense, gram for gram):

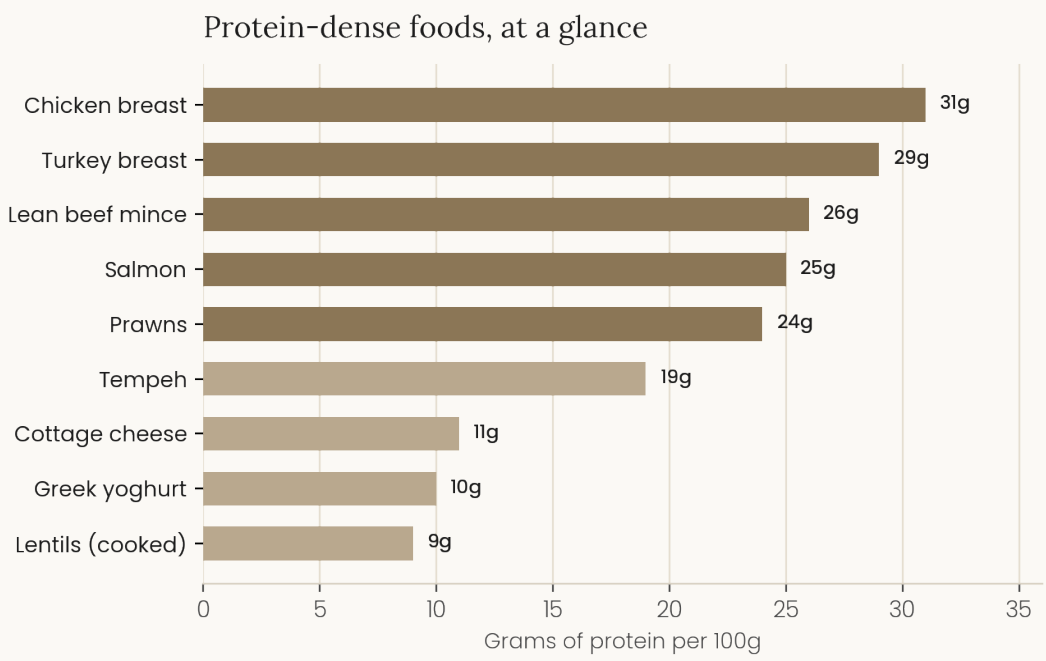
- Chicken breast, roughly 31g protein per 100g
- Turkey breast, roughly 29g protein per 100g
- Lean beef mince, roughly 26g protein per 100g
- White fish (barramundi, snapper), roughly 22g protein per 100g
- Salmon, roughly 25g protein per 100g, with the added benefit of omega-3s
- Eggs, roughly 6g protein per egg
- Greek yoghurt, roughly 10g protein per 100g
- Cottage cheese, roughly 11g protein per 100g
- Prawns, roughly 24g protein per 100g

Plant-based and other sources:

- Tofu, roughly 8g protein per 100g
- Tempeh, roughly 19g protein per 100g
- Lentils (cooked), roughly 9g protein per 100g
- Chickpeas (cooked), roughly 9g protein per 100g
- Edamame, roughly 11g protein per 100g
- Protein powder (whey or plant-based), typically 20-25g per scoop

- Skyr or high-protein yoghurt, often 10-12g protein per 100g

You don't need to eat all of these. Pick four or five from this list that you actually enjoy and build your meals around them, sustainability comes from eating food you like, not forcing down chicken breast if you don't enjoy it.



Grams of protein per 100g, for reference.

4. Simple Meal Templates

Rather than following a rigid meal plan, use these as flexible templates you can adapt to whatever you have on hand.

- **Breakfast:** a protein source (eggs, Greek yoghurt, or a protein shake) plus a carbohydrate (oats, toast, fruit) plus something for flavour (nut butter, berries, honey). Example: Greek yoghurt with berries, honey, and a sprinkle of granola.
- **Lunch:** a palm-sized protein source plus a fist-sized carbohydrate plus a generous portion of vegetables plus a small amount of healthy fat. Example: grilled chicken, brown rice, roasted vegetables, and an olive oil dressing.

- **Dinner:** the same structure as lunch, adjusted to preference, so you're not reinventing your approach every meal. Example: salmon, sweet potato, steamed greens, and a squeeze of lemon.
- **Snacks:** pair a protein source with something else for satisfaction. Examples: cottage cheese with fruit, a protein shake, boiled eggs, or Greek yoghurt with a spoon of peanut butter.

Once you've internalised this "protein plus carb plus veg plus fat" structure, you stop needing recipes for every meal, you can build something reasonable out of whatever's in the fridge.

5. Eating Out And Hitting Your Protein Target

Eating at restaurants or getting takeaway doesn't have to derail your protein intake.

Choose protein-forward options: grilled over battered, a protein bowl over a pasta dish, a burger without the bun if you want to reduce the carb load, or extra protein add-ons where available (extra chicken, an additional egg).

Don't be afraid to ask for adjustments, most places are happy to sub extra vegetables for chips, or add an extra protein portion for a small cost.

If you know a meal out is coming up, you don't need to "save calories" by starving beforehand, focus instead on getting a solid protein source earlier in the day so the meal out isn't your only opportunity to hit your target.

6. Common Protein Mistakes

Only eating protein at dinner. Spreading your intake across three or four meals is both easier to hit and more effective for muscle preservation than trying to eat it all in one sitting.

Relying too heavily on protein bars and shakes. These are useful tools, particularly when time-poor, but whole food sources tend to be more filling and nutritionally complete. Use supplements to fill gaps, not as the entire strategy.

Underestimating portion sizes. A "chicken breast" at a restaurant can vary wildly in size. When in doubt, a portion roughly the size of your palm is a reasonable baseline estimate.

Forgetting protein at breakfast. This is the meal most women under-prioritise for protein, and it's often the easiest place to make an immediate improvement, a couple of eggs or a scoop of protein in your porridge makes a meaningful difference.

Thinking you need to hit your number perfectly every day. A day or two below target isn't going to undo your progress. What matters is the pattern over weeks and months, not any single day.



Emily Gray

Clinical Exercise Physiologist & Myotherapist. She's coached 450+ women through sustainable weight loss, and built Fitness By Em to give women the personalised, evidence-based coaching the fitness industry usually skips.

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Getting your nutrition dialled in is one piece of the puzzle, pairing it with the right training and a plan that's actually built around your body and your life is what makes it click into place.

If you'd like a personalised nutrition approach as part of a full coaching plan, book a free 30-minute call. We'll talk through your goals, your current eating patterns, and what a sustainable plan could look like for you specifically.

Book a free call: calendly.com/emilygray81099/free-30min-consult-call
Instagram: instagram.com/_fitnessbyem_
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